

[SPECIMEN · THE HALL]

BUREAUCRACY, BY DESIGN.

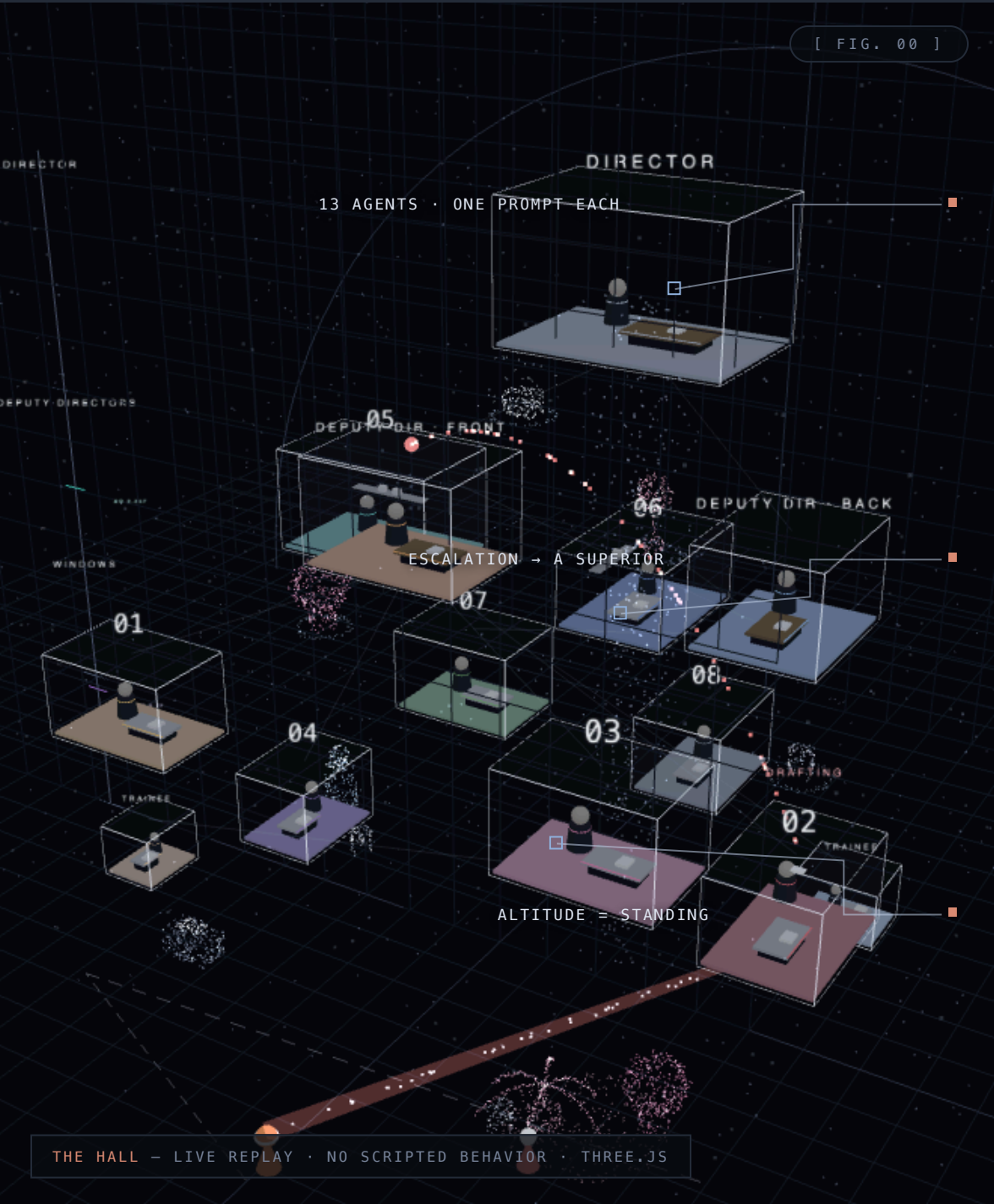
Does bureaucracy need bureaucrats?

A fictional public-service hall staffed entirely by AI agents — built to test whether bureaucracy emerges from organizational structure alone.

[CORE THREADS OF THE PROJECT]

- 01 Premise — conditions, not characters
- 02 Research — Weber, Kafka, the files, the queue
- 03 Method — an ablation experiment on structure
- 04 Finding — the theater rises with the switches
- 05 Output — a hall you can walk into

NOT A THESIS — A PROTOTYPE



[FIG. 00]

[01-02 · RESEARCH PLATES]

What the project leans on



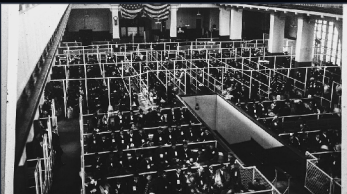
REF-01
Max Weber, 1918
Bureaucracy as an ideal type: offices, files, rules — conditions, not characters.
→ BECAME: THE SWITCHABLE CONDITIONS



REF-02
Franz Kafka, 1923
The Trial: doors, delays, doorkeepers you never get past.
→ BECAME: THE CITIZEN KEPT OUTSIDE



REF-03
Card Division, LoC, c. 1915
The institution's memory, outliving every clerk who serves it.
→ BECAME: PAPER TRAIL & ARCHIVE



REF-04
Ellis Island pens, c. 1907
Waiting, sorted into pens: the queue as the state's true interface.
→ BECAME: REFERRAL AS MOVEMENT

Red tape is not malice — it is mechanism. Divided permission, mandatory records, bounded remits: each rule is sensible alone; combined, they turn a simple request into something referred, supplemented, escalated, archived — not necessarily resolved.

[03 · METHOD]

Bureaucracy, decomposed into conditions

STRUCTURE

Hierarchy

ABLATED ☒

Jurisdiction

Permission boundary

RECORD

Paper trail

ABLATED ☒

Accountability

Memory

ABLATED ☒

Archive

MOTION

Escalation

Assignment

MEASUREMENT — EVENT STREAM

- 13 AGENTS — SUBJECTS · CONDITIONS ONLY
- SYNTHETIC VISITORS — STIMULI · KEPT APART
- 75 CASES · 5 ORGANIZATIONAL CONDITIONS
- 9 MECHANICAL + 5 TEXT CODES · TWO PASSES
- PREREGISTERED · CROSS-FAMILY CODER

[04 · FINDING]

□

WHATEVER BUREAUCRACY APPEARS, APPEARS ON ITS OWN.

- F1 With every condition on, a simple request gathers referrals, memos and supplementary demands — nobody was told to do any of this.
- F2 Switch hierarchy, paper trail or memory off one at a time, and the matching behaviors thin out with them.
- F3 A lone agent, handed the same matter, simply answers it.

[05 · OUTPUT — A HALL YOU CAN WALK INTO]

Submit a matter, then watch it be referred, escalated and archived between desks — the way it feels to wait at any counter.

LIVE > ai-bureaucratism.vercel.app

/PORTFOLIO

/STUDY



FIVE HALLS, FOUR REJECTED — FORM HAD TO MAKE RANK